Inbound Lead Report: Rodrigo Castillo - Sociedad Quimica y Minera de Chile (SQM)

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> **P1 account expansion: SQM's Head of Operations (Northern Operations Division) wants autonomous drone inspection for 3 large-scale 24/7 Atacama lithium sites to replace expensive, hazardous contracted crews. He was referred by Anglo American, the Q3 budget conversation is already scheduled, and SQM already runs FlytBase with Adentu in its iodine operation [S1].**

Assignment requirements check

Each requirement in the assignment PDF, checked in Python against the stage output.

Stage	Requirement	Met
1 Qualification	Framework stated and explained	yes
1 Qualification	Known information extracted from the email (Identify Pain)	yes
1 Qualification	Missing information required for full qualification (Metrics, Economic Buyer, Decision Criteria, Decision Process, Paper Process, Champion, Competition)	yes
1 Qualification	Fit assessment (every ICP factor rated with a reason)	yes
1 Qualification	Priority score with reasoning (73/100, P1 - Hot: respond same business day, involve AE early)	yes
2 Deep account research	Organizational structure and reporting lines (INFERENCE (not sourced): no public source found names a 'Northern Operations Division' or the contact, Rodrigo Castillo. If his three sites are Salar de Atacama lithium operations, his role most likely sits in Novandino's operations line, reporting into the salar or lithium operations managers named in the DF organigram, who report to the Novandino General Manager; budget	yes

Stage	Requirement	Met
	for a multi-site deployment would probably need GM-level approval with input from maintenance and automation, digitalization/IT, risk management and supply chain. If the sites are instead iodine/nitrate operations in Tarapacá/Antofagasta, the line would run through SQM's Iodine and Plant Nutrition division, where the existing drone program sits.)	
2 Deep account research	Budget signals from public filings (capex, opex, technology)	yes
2 Deep account research	Recent news, press releases, strategic announcements	yes
2 Deep account research	Stakeholder or investor letters revealing priorities	yes
2 Deep account research	Synthesized FlytBase positioning recommendation	yes
2 Deep account research	All research real: every kept claim cites a stored source and passed the fact-check (43 claims checked, 0 removed)	yes
3 Response generation	Reflects Stage 2 research (each email cites kept research) (email 1: S1; email 2: S25, S1; email 3: S1; email 4: none)	yes
3 Response generation	Aims to discover the Stage 1 unknowns (email 1: Metrics, Economic Buyer; email 2: Decision Criteria; email 3: Paper Process; email 4: Champion)	yes
3 Response generation	Tone adapted to seniority, industry and stated context	yes
3 Response generation	Clear progression logic (why this email, then this email) (4 emails, 8 reply branches)	yes
3 Response generation	Playbook: Email 1 fits one phone screen (<= 200 words) (193 words)	yes
3 Response generation	Playbook: Email 1 asks at most 2 questions plus the CTA (<= 3 '?') (3 question marks)	yes
3 Response generation	Playbook: Email 1 CTA offers two specific time options (11:00, 15:00)	yes

Stage	Requirement	Met
3 Response generation	Playbook: Email 1 is about the buyer (you/your >= we/our, <= 2 sentences start with I/We) (you 9 vs we 0; 0 I/We sentence starts)	yes
3 Response generation	Playbook: every follow-up is shorter than Email 1 and <= 120 words (email 2: 99 words; email 3: 93 words; email 4: 63 words)	yes
3 Response generation	Playbook: one ask, at most 1 link per email (email 1: 0; email 2: 0; email 3: 0; email 4: 0)	yes
3 Response generation	Playbook: no banned phrases, buzzwords, AI tells or placeholders (clean)	yes
3 Response generation	Playbook: subjects describe the content (<= 8 words, no '!', emoji or fake Fwd:) (ok)	yes
3 Response generation	Playbook: every email signed by the named BDR (ok)	yes
3 Response generation	Playbook: final email closes the loop respectfully (close the loop, check back)	yes
4 Case study matching	Autonomously searched FlytBase's public website for case studies (25 case studies scanned)	yes
4 Case study matching	Referral connection identified (no hard-coding) (found=True https://flytbase.com/case-studies/anglo-american-autonomous-mining-drones-peru-case-study)	yes
4 Case study matching	Matched on industry, use case and operational context	yes
4 Case study matching	Explains why the case study is the strongest fit (How SQM Turned a 678 km^2 Mine into an Autonomous Inspection Zone)	yes
4 Case study matching	Primary match is a page the crawler actually read	yes
5 Partner identification	Direct AE or partner-led motion for the region decided (AE-led with partner (co-sell))	yes
5 Partner identification	Justified by region, deal complexity and partner availability	yes
5 Partner identification	If partner-led: specific partner type and rationale (Adentu (System Integrator), Dronestore Chile (System Integrator), UAVLatam (System Integrator))	yes
5 Partner identification	Every named partner appears in a stored source	yes
6 AE handoff	Buyer context: who he is, what he cares about, who else is involved	yes

Stage	Requirement	Met
6 AE handoff	Qualification status: framework score, knowns, unknowns	yes
6 AE handoff	Top 3 research highlights, each citing kept research	yes
6 AE handoff	Recommended case study and why	yes
6 AE handoff	Suggested next step with rationale (Confirm the existing SQM account owner and Adentu's partner status, and agree deal registration and roles. Then send Email 1 and hold a 30-minute discovery call with Rodrigo Castillo on Wed 11 Nov 11:00 or Thu 12 Nov 15:00 Santiago time. Use the call to map the 3 sites to an entity, the Q3 budget attendees and signer, crew cost and frequency, and decision criteria.)	yes

Stage 1 - Qualification (MEDDPICC)

Why MEDDPICC: MEDDPICC fits this lead because it is an enterprise industrial purchase: 3 large-scale, 24/7 lithium sites in the Atacama, which means operations, safety, IT/OT and procurement will all weigh in. The contact (Head of Operations, Northern Operations Division) is a strong operational owner, but the email does not name who signs, and the 'internal budget conversation scheduled for Q3' hints at a formal budget and decision cycle that MEDDPICC tracks explicitly (Economic Buyer, Decision Process, Paper Process). The Anglo American referral, and the likely role of a LATAM integrator/reseller, add relationship and partner dynamics that BANT does not capture. BANT would score this lead as 'need + timing' and stop there, missing the buying committee and paper path. SPICED is built for recurring SaaS expansion and customer-success motions, not a first multi-site hardware-plus-software deployment. MEDDPICC also makes the gaps explicit (no metrics, criteria, champion confirmation or competition stated), which tells the BDR what the first emails must uncover.

ICP fit	MEDDPICC completeness	Priority score	Tier
88/100	38%	**73/100**	P1 - Hot: respond same business day, involve AE early

Formula: priority = 0.7 x ICP fit + 0.3 x MEDDPICC completeness; tier set by ICP fit (>=75 P1, >=55 P2)

Element	Status	Known from email	Missing	Discovery question
Metrics	partial	Contracted crews are expensive and hazardous	Quantified current spend on contracted crews, inspection frequency, incident rates, and target savings or coverage	Roughly what do the contracted inspection crews cost you per year across the three sites, and how often do they inspect?
Economic Buyer	partial	Internal budget conversation scheduled for Q3	Who owns the budget and signs off (Rodrigo, a VP of Operations, or corporate)	Who besides yourself will be in the Q3 budget conversation, and who makes the final sign-off?
Decision Criteria	unknown	-	Technical and commercial criteria: desert/dust/heat performance, autonomy level, integration with existing systems, data security, pricing model	What would a drone inspection solution need to prove to work in Atacama conditions around the clock?
Decision Process	partial	Internal budget conversation scheduled for Q3	Steps after the budget conversation, stakeholders involved (safety, IT/OT, procurement), pilot expectations and target go-live	After the Q3 budget conversation, what steps would a project like this go through, for example a pilot at one site first?
Paper Process	unknown	-	Procurement path, vendor onboarding, legal/security review, preference for buying direct or through a local partner	How does SQM usually procure new technology like this: direct from the vendor or through a local integrator, and is there a security or vendor review?
Identify Pain	known	Contracted crews are expensive and hazardous	Consequence and urgency: specific incidents, downtime, or compliance pressure driving the change now	What is driving the move away from contracted crews now: a safety incident, cost pressure, or expanding production?
Champion	partial	Rodrigo Castillo, Head of Operations, Northern	Whether Rodrigo will actively sponsor the	Would you be the one leading this internally,

Element	Status	Known from email	Missing	Discovery question
		Operations Division, reached out proactively via flytbase.com/contact	project internally and has influence over the budget decision	and who else should we involve early so the Q3 discussion goes well?
Competition	unknown	-	Status quo (contracted crews) is the known alternative; other drone vendors or in-house options being evaluated are not stated	Are you looking at any other drone or robotics solutions, or would the alternative be staying with the contracted crews?

Fit assessment

Factor	Weight	Rating (0-5)	Reason
industry_fit	20	5	Mining: 'large-scale, 24/7 lithium extraction sites in the Atacama Desert' is heavy industry with large outdoor assets.
site_scale	15	5	'3 large-scale ... lithium extraction sites' is a multi-site deployment.
continuous_operations	10	5	Email states the sites run '24/7'.
pain_severity	15	4	'Contracted crews are expensive and hazardous' is cost plus safety pain that autonomy removes directly, but it is not quantified.
buyer_authority	15	4	'Head of Operations, Northern Operations Division' owns operations but is not confirmed as the budget signer.
warm_introduction	10	5	'Referred by Anglo American', a major mining peer.
timing_and_budget	15	3	'Internal budget conversation scheduled for Q3' gives a timeline but no budget amount or approval yet.

Verdict: SQM is a near-ideal ICP fit: a major Chilean lithium miner with 3 large-scale 24/7 Atacama sites, clear cost and safety pain, a senior operations contact, and a warm referral from Anglo American. Priority is high, held back only by unknown economic buyer, decision criteria, paper process and competition, and a budget that is still pending the Q3 conversation.

Risks: Budget is not yet approved; it depends on the Q3 internal conversation; Economic buyer and sign-off path are unknown; Procurement path unknown; a large mining company may require long vendor onboarding or a local partner; Harsh Atacama conditions (dust, heat, altitude, wind) may

raise technical evaluation hurdles; No quantified metrics yet to build an ROI case; Competitors or the status quo of contracted crews may be entrenched

Stage 2 - Deep Account Research

Organisational structure

- On December 27, 2025, Codelco and SQM announced the creation of Nova Andino Litio SpA (merger of Minera Tarar SpA and SQM Salar SpA), the joint venture that will run lithium exploration, production and commercialization in the Salar de Atacama until 2060. [S9]
- *So what:* If the lead's sites are lithium operations in the Salar de Atacama, the contracting entity is likely Novandino, not SQM S.A.; FlytBase must confirm this early.
- The Novandino board has three Codelco directors (Máximo Pacheco, Josefina Montenegro, Alfredo Moreno) and three SQM directors (Ricardo Ramos, Hernán Uribe, Manuel Ovalle), with Pacheco as chairman and Ramos as vice-chairman. [S9, S13, S14]
- *So what:* A public-private board means state-company governance and transparency expectations may apply to larger technology spends.
- Per Diario Financiero (December 2025), Carlos Díaz, previously general manager of SQM Litio, was appointed general manager of Nova Andino, and Codelco's Eduardo Foix was named finance manager. [S12, S13]
- *So what:* Díaz is the top executive of the lithium business and the likely ultimate sponsor of a multi-site lithium deployment.
- Diario Financiero reports Novandino starts with the 3,533 workers of SQM Litio, operating from the same offices, with Codelco not contributing workers, and a transition from 2026 to 2030 before the agreement is fully in force from 2031. [S13, S14]
- *So what:* Operational teams and decision-makers are the same SQM Litio people, so existing SQM relationships (including the iodine drone program) remain relevant.
- Diario Financiero's December 2025 organigram of Díaz's direct team includes Gilbert Maldonado (salar operations manager), Humberto Carvajal (lithium operations manager), Gerson Salas (maintenance and automation manager), Rodrigo Maffioletti (VP lithium projects) and Germán Pérez (supply chain manager), and places Andrés Pinto (digitalization and IT manager) and Luis Acuña (risk management superintendency) under José Miguel Berguño, VP corporate services and sustainability. [S12] *(partially verified)*
- *So what:* This gives the BDR a concrete buying committee: operations, maintenance/automation, IT/digital, risk and supply chain.

Stakeholders found in public sources

- **Carlos Díaz**, General Manager, Nova Andino Litio (formerly GM of SQM Litio) - Top executive of the lithium business; likely final sponsor for a multi-site lithium deployment. [S12, S13]
- **Gilbert Maldonado**, Gerente de operaciones salar (salar operations manager) - Runs Salar de Atacama field operations where docks would be installed. [S12]
- **Humberto Carvajal**, Gerente de operaciones litio (lithium operations manager) - Operational owner of lithium production; peer or superior of the inbound contact. [S12]
- **Gerson Salas**, Gerente de mantenimiento y automatización (maintenance and automation manager) - Owns automation and asset inspection; natural technical evaluator for drone-in-a-box. [S12]
- **Andrés Pinto**, Gerente de digitalización y TI (digitalization and IT manager) - IT/OT and data integration sign-off (network, cloud, cybersecurity). [S12]
- **Luis Acuña**, Head of the Superintendencia de Gestión de Riesgos (risk management) - Safety and risk case for removing people from hazardous inspection work. [S12]
- **Germán Pérez**, Gerente supply chain - Likely owner of vendor onboarding and procurement path. [S12]
- **Rodrigo Toler**, Deputy Manager of Digital Innovation, SQM - Internal champion of the existing SQM FlytBase/Adentu drone program; a reference inside the same group. [S1]
- **Matías Gatica**, Director de Transformación Digital, SQM YNV (Iodine and Plant Nutrition) - Owns the iodine/nitrates data platform (AVEVA PI, Databricks) that drone data could feed. [S23]

Likely reporting line (inference): INFERENCE (not sourced): no public source found names a 'Northern Operations Division' or the contact, Rodrigo Castillo. If his three sites are Salar de Atacama lithium operations, his role most likely sits in Novandino's operations line, reporting into the salar or lithium operations managers named in the DF organigram, who report to the Novandino General Manager; budget for a multi-site deployment would probably need GM-level approval with input from maintenance and automation, digitalization/IT, risk management and supply chain. If the sites are instead iodine/nitrate operations in Tarapacá/Antofagasta, the line would run through SQM's Iodine and Plant Nutrition division, where the existing drone program sits.

Budget signals (capex / opex / technology)

- In its 2Q2026 earnings release (August 18, 2026), SQM guided capital expenditures of approximately US$3 billion for 2026-2028, roughly 60% for Novandino, 20% for Iodine and Plant Nutrition and 20% for the International Lithium Division, including about US$300 million per year of sustaining capex across all divisions. [S10]
- *So what:* About US$1.8B of 2026-2028 capex is earmarked for Novandino, and a sustaining-capex pool of roughly US$300M per year is the kind of budget an inspection-automation project can be funded from.

- In November 2025 SQM had cut its 2025-2027 capex estimate to US$2.7 billion (about 25% for maintenance), from a previous US$3.1-3.8 billion range, delaying some investment decisions without changing production targets. [S7, S8]
- *So what:* SQM was capital-disciplined through 2025; FlytBase should frame the project as opex/cost reduction with fast payback, not as discretionary capex.
- Novandino submitted environmental and technical documentation for the Salar Futuro project in July 2026; it contemplates about US$3 billion of capital investment over roughly seven years after approvals. [S10]
- *So what:* A long expansion pipeline at the Salar de Atacama means more assets and construction areas to monitor, which supports a scalable autonomous inspection platform.
- SQM's 2Q2026 release says Novandino expects to produce 280,000-290,000 metric tons LCE in 2026 and to surpass 300,000 metric tons of capacity by end-2027, and that the Chilean lithium hydroxide plant is being converted to dual-purpose by mid-2027. [S10]
- *So what:* Running at full capacity raises the cost of unplanned downtime, strengthening the ROI case for more frequent automated inspections.
- FlytBase's published SQM case study reports the iodine irrigation-inspection system cost between USD 70,000 and 80,000 in total and reached ROI in less than a year. [S1]
- *So what:* There is an internal SQM benchmark for drone-program cost and payback that the lead's Q3 budget discussion can reuse.

Recent news and announcements

- SQM's Q1 2026 results (May 26, 2026) were the first full quarter operating with Codelco through Nova Andino Litio; the CEO said operations were at full capacity and Novandino generated more than US$530 million in contributions to the Chilean state in the quarter. [S11]
- *So what:* The JV is operational and profitable, so the organization is stabilizing and can take on new operational projects.
- SQM reported 2025 net income of US$588.1 million versus a loss in 2024, with record Q4 2025 lithium sales volumes of more than 66,000 metric tons, per The Clinic (February 28, 2026). [S20]
- *So what:* The return to profit removes the 2024 cost-cutting backdrop that could have stalled a new tech purchase.
- On February 18, 2026, Chile's Dirección del Trabajo partially suspended work at SQM Salar (about 2,300 m altitude, San Pedro de Atacama) over drinking-water and sanitation shortfalls, and also suspended a contractor operating there for insufficient personal protective equipment against weather and temperature swings. [S25]
- *So what:* Regulators are scrutinizing working conditions for outdoor and contractor crews at the salar, which supports the lead's stated pain that contracted crews are hazardous and reinforces the case to reduce field exposure.
- On October 29, 2026, Reporte Minero reported that SQM launched the unified SQM Group identity covering SQM, Novandino Litio and SQM Litio Internacional. [S24]

- *So what:* A group-level structure could let a proven drone platform be standardized across entities, a bigger deal than one division.
- In its 1Q2026 release, SQM said IRMA's surveillance audit of the Salar de Atacama kept the operation at level 75 and highlighted improvements in safety performance and emergency preparedness, and that SQM began implementing ISO 37301 compliance management with certification expected in Q4 2026. [S11]
- *So what:* Safety and compliance certifications are live priorities; autonomous inspection with logged, auditable missions fits that narrative.

Investor / stakeholder priorities

- In the Q3 2025 release, CEO Ricardo Ramos emphasized 'maintaining low costs and strong operating efficiency at our Atacama operations' alongside record lithium sales volumes. [S7]
- *So what:* Cost and efficiency in the Atacama are stated CEO priorities, which matches replacing expensive contracted inspection crews.
- In the 2Q2026 release, Ramos said Salar Futuro is designed to significantly reduce the environmental footprint, including eliminating continental water use at the Salar de Atacama and using renewable energy. [S10]
- *So what:* Environmental footprint is a top message to investors; drone monitoring can support environmental and asset monitoring, not just maintenance inspection.
- In the 1Q2026 release, Ramos said SQM believes it is well positioned to deliver solid results and improved returns to shareholders while advancing expansion plans in lithium and iodine. [S11]
- *So what:* Growth plus returns means projects need a clear payback; FlytBase should lead with ROI from the existing SQM case.
- In its Q4 2025 results, SQM attributed record volumes to long-term capacity expansion and to innovation in producing lithium from lithium sulfate, which allows more lithium with lower brine extraction (The Clinic, February 2026). [S20]
- *So what:* Leadership publicly credits technology and process innovation for results, a receptive frame for autonomy.

Operations context

- The Dirección del Trabajo describes SQM Salar as located at about 2,300 metres altitude in San Pedro de Atacama, with outdoor workers exposed to significant thermal swings. [S25]
- *So what:* Altitude, heat and temperature swings are the conditions docks must handle; FlytBase should bring evidence of desert performance (the SQM iodine deployment reported more than 95% mission reliability).
- The DF article lists the Carmen Lithium Chemical Plant east of Antofagasta, described as the world's largest lithium refinery with 210 thousand tonnes LCE of processing capacity and a 240 thousand tonne target for 2026, among the assets transferred into Nova Andino. [S13]

- *So what:* Lithium operations span both the salar and a large chemical plant, so the three sites may include plant as well as brine-field assets with different inspection needs.
- FlytBase's case study says SQM's iodine operation covers a 678 km^2 mining area in northern Chile, where manual inspections previously meant engineers walking or driving kilometres daily. [S1, S15]
- *So what:* SQM already knows the walking-inspection problem at scale and has seen the drone alternative work internally.
- Reporte Minero reported a worker died in an accident at SQM's Nueva Victoria site (Tarapacá) on February 14, 2024; SQM said the victim was a crane-truck operator and operations were suspended in the area. [S26]
- *So what:* Fatal incidents at SQM sites make reducing people's exposure in the field a credible safety argument.
- SQM's 2Q2026 release says Novandino is converting the Chilean lithium hydroxide plant to a dual-purpose facility by mid-2027 and has introduced lithium sulfate production at the Salar de Atacama. [S10]
- *So what:* Ongoing construction and process change add inspection and progress-monitoring needs.

Technology and drone adoption

- FlytBase's published case study says SQM, with Chilean integrator Adentu, deployed DJI Dock drones on FlytBase across a 678 km^2 operation, running two autonomous missions a day with RGB and thermal data sent to SQM's Azure environment, doubling inspection frequency and reaching more than 95% mission reliability. [S1]
- *So what:* SQM is already a FlytBase customer in iodine; the lead is an expansion into lithium, and the known integrator (Adentu) and data stack (Azure) cut technical risk.
- The same case study says SQM ordered additional DJI Docks for its security department for 24/7 surveillance and plans FlytBase AI-R edge analytics and BVLOS operations; a second FlytBase page says four more docks were on order. [S1, S15]
- *So what:* Other SQM departments are already copying the model, which supports a group-wide standard and 24/7 operations that match the lead's 24/7 sites.
- An ANDRITZ success story describes a phased transformation at SQM's lithium operations covering asset management, automation, optimization and digital twins at the PQLC plant, and notes the establishment of an Automation and Energy Management Department. [S21]
- *So what:* The lithium side already invests in automation and asset monitoring; drone inspection data can plug into that program.
- SQM's Iodine and Plant Nutrition division adopted AVEVA PI System with Databricks and AI models reported at about 90% predictive accuracy, and the article says the infrastructure could extend to lithium. [S23]

- *So what:* SQM has a data platform where drone-derived insights can land; FlytBase should stress API integration.
- Reporte Minero (May 2025) reports SQM Iodine and Plant Nutrition uses the Lean M1+ methodology with multidisciplinary cells of data-analytics, AI and operations specialists. [S22]
- *So what:* An internal culture for piloting and scaling digital tools makes a pilot-then-scale proposal fit how SQM adopts technology.

Positioning recommendation: Position FlytBase as the proven autonomy platform SQM already runs in its iodine operations, now extended to the lead's three 24/7 lithium sites: same integrator model (Adentu), same Azure data path, desert-proven reliability. Frame the deal as an operating-cost and safety project funded from the sustaining-capex pool rather than a new discretionary capex line, with payback benchmarked on the SQM iodine case. Because the lithium sites now sit in Novandino (the Codelco-SQM JV), confirm early which entity contracts and bring a governance-ready package (security, compliance, auditability) suited to a public-private board. Propose a one-site pilot before the Q3 budget conversation, with a roadmap to all three sites and to 24/7 security and environmental monitoring.

- Internal reference: SQM's own iodine program on FlytBase with Adentu doubled inspection frequency, reported >95% mission reliability and paid back in under a year on a USD 70-80k system [S1]; offer an introduction to Rodrigo Toler, Deputy Manager of Digital Innovation [S1].
- Budget fit: ~US$3B 2026-2028 capex with ~60% for Novandino and ~US$300M per year of sustaining capex [S10]; position the rollout as sustaining/opex-lowering, consistent with management's capital discipline after the 2025 capex cut [S7][S8].
- Safety and compliance: the February 2026 Dirección del Trabajo partial suspension at SQM Salar, including a contractor suspended over PPE [S25], plus IRMA safety focus and ISO 37301 rollout [S11], support reducing field exposure through remote, logged missions.
- 24/7 match: SQM already ordered extra docks for 24/7 security surveillance [S1], so one platform can cover inspection by day and security around the clock at the lithium sites.
- Integration: drone data can feed the existing Azure path [S1] and the AVEVA/Databricks platform that SQM says could extend to lithium [S23], plus the ANDRITZ asset-management program at the lithium plant [S21].
- Scale story: Salar Futuro (~US$3B over about seven years) [S10] and 300k t LCE capacity by end-2027 [S10] mean more assets to monitor; sell a platform, not a point solution.

Likely objections: Entity and governance: lithium assets moved into Novandino with a 3+3 Codelco/SQM board [S9][S13]; procurement may follow new JV rules, and the iodine reference may sit in a different legal entity.; The contact's 'Northern Operations Division' does not appear in any public org source found, so the sites may not be the Salar de Atacama lithium operations; confirm site names and owner before quoting.; Capital discipline: SQM delayed some investment decisions in 2025 [S7][S8]; a large multi-site upfront spend may be pushed back.; Harsh conditions (about 2,300

m altitude, large thermal swings) [S25] will drive technical scrutiny; the iodine case reliability data is vendor-published [S1] and SQM may want its own validation.; Reputational and legal noise around SQM (court activity on the 'Caso SQM' was being discussed on r/chile in 2026) [S28][S29] is anecdotal and unrelated to operations, but adds to public scrutiny of the group.; Incumbent automation vendors (ANDRITZ, AVEVA) [S21][S23] and in-house contractors may compete for the same budget.

Searched for but not found: Any public source naming a 'Northern Operations Division' at SQM or Novandino, or the contact Rodrigo Castillo and his reporting line.; Which three sites the lead means (Salar de Atacama brine field, Carmen Lithium Chemical Plant, or other) - not identifiable from public sources.; SQM's spend on contracted inspection crews, or any public figure on inspection or maintenance opex.; Safety statistics (lost-time injury frequency) for SQM or Novandino in 2024-2025 from a sustainability report; the sustainability report page was blocked.; The text of the 2025 annual report chairman/CEO letter; the FY2025 20-F page only returned XBRL header data, so it is not cited.; Q3 2026 results (not yet published as of the research date) and FY2026 capex actuals.; Any public record of the Anglo American relationship with SQM beyond FlytBase's own case studies.; LinkedIn pages for the named stakeholders (Chrome tools not used); names come from Diario Financiero and FlytBase case studies only.; Practitioner Reddit discussion of SQM operations or drone use at the Atacama; r/mining and r/drones searches timed out or returned unrelated posts.

Fact-check: 0 claim(s) were removed because the cited source did not support them.

Stage 3 - Adaptive Email Sequence

Strategy: Mr. Castillo asked us, so Email 1 answers his request in his own terms (three 24/7 Atacama lithium sites, costly and hazardous contracted crews, Anglo American referral, Q3 budget) and leads with the strongest verified proof: SQM's own published FlytBase deployment in northern Chile [S1]. Each follow-up then adds one new useful item tied to a different MEDDPICC gap: Atacama operating conditions and SQM's move to 24/7 dock surveillance (Decision Criteria), a forwardable five-bullet summary for his safety, IT and procurement colleagues (Paper Process), and a close-the-loop note that offers to hold until his Q3 budget conversation (Champion). Asks get smaller as the thread goes quiet, from a call with two slots to a yes/no on timing.

Email 1 - Friday 6 November 2026, within 1 hour of the inbound (same business hour, Santiago time)

Goal: Confirm we understood his request, show the closest proof (SQM's own deployment), open the two most important gaps and book a 30-minute call with the AE.
Gaps targeted: Metrics, Economic Buyer

Why this email now: He asked us directly and the lead is P1, so a specific reply within the business hour matters more than anything else. Mirroring his own words earns agreement, and the SQM case [S1] is proof from inside his own company and desert.
Success signal: He accepts a slot, says how his sites relate to the iodine programme, or names who joins the Q3 conversation.
Research used: [S1]

Subject: Re: Autonomous inspection for our Atacama lithium sites

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Dear Mr. Castillo,

Thank you for your note, and for the referral from Anglo American. You are looking for drone-
based inspection across three large-scale, 24/7 lithium sites in the Atacama, so that you rely
less on contracted crews that are expensive and hazardous, ahead of your Q3 budget
conversation.

Docked drones flying scheduled missions at each site can reduce how often people go into the
field, and give your Q3 discussion measured results rather than estimates.

Your own company is the closest reference. FlytBase's published case study describes SQM's
iodine operation across 678 km2 in northern Chile running two autonomous dock missions a day,
which doubled inspection frequency with more than 95% mission reliability.

Two questions to prepare:
1. How do your three sites relate to that programme, and how often do contracted crews inspect
them today?
2. Besides yourself, who will take part in the Q3 budget conversation?

Would Wednesday 11 November at 11:00 or Thursday 12 November at 15:00, Santiago time, suit a
30-minute call? You are welcome to bring a safety or IT colleague.

Con gusto podemos continuar en español.

Kind regards,
Samruddhi Sontakke
Business Development, FlytBase
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Email 2 - Tuesday 10 November 2026, 10:30 Santiago time (+2 business days), same thread

Goal: Add one useful point on operating conditions and learn what a system must prove at his sites.
Gaps targeted: Decision Criteria
Why this email now: Two business days is enough for a senior buyer to have read Email 1. A new, relevant fact about his operating environment and a 24/7 use inside SQM is more useful than a

reminder.
Success signal: He lists technical criteria (heat, dust, altitude, night flights, integration) or accepts a slot.
Research used: [S25, S1]

Subject: Re: Autonomous inspection for our Atacama lithium sites

```
Dear Mr. Castillo,

One point on Atacama conditions. Chile's labour authority describes SQM Salar at about 2,300
metres, with strong temperature swings for outdoor workers. The same FlytBase case study notes
that SQM's security department has ordered additional docks to run 24/7 surveillance, which is
close to your round-the-clock requirement.

What would a system need to prove at your sites, for example heat, dust, wind or night
operation, before you trusted it around the clock?

Wednesday 11:00 or Thursday 15:00 Santiago time remain open for a 30-minute call.

Kind regards,
Samruddhi Sontakke
Business Development, FlytBase
```

Email 3 - Tuesday 17 November 2026, 11:00 Santiago time (about +7 business days), same thread

Goal: Equip him to share the idea internally and learn how SQM buys this kind of technology.
Gaps targeted: Paper Process
Why this email now: Enterprise mining purchases involve operations, safety, IT and supply chain. By touch 3 the playbook calls for a forwardable summary so he can act as our champion without extra work.
Success signal: He forwards the summary, names a procurement route (direct or integrator), or copies a colleague.
Research used: [S1]

Subject: Re: Autonomous inspection for our Atacama lithium sites

```
Dear Mr. Castillo,

In case it helps, here is a summary you can forward to safety, IT or procurement:
- Problem: contracted inspection crews at three 24/7 Atacama sites are costly and exposed.
- Approach: docked drones fly scheduled RGB and thermal missions.
- Safety: fewer routine trips into hazardous areas.
```

```
- IT: SQM's iodine programme already sends drone data to its Azure environment.
- Next step: scope one site before Q3.

Does SQM usually buy technology like this directly or through a local integrator?

Kind regards,
Samruddhi Sontakke
Business Development, FlytBase
```

Email 4 - Wednesday 25 November 2026, 11:00 Santiago time (about +13 business days), same thread

Goal: Close the loop without pressure, offer to hold until Q3 and confirm who leads this.
Gaps targeted: Champion
Why this email now: After three useful touches with no reply, more emails would cost goodwill. A clear, no-guilt close respects a senior Chilean buyer and ties the next contact to his own Q3 timeline.
Success signal: He gives a check-back date, names the internal lead, or replies that the timing is now right.

Subject: Re: Autonomous inspection for our Atacama lithium sites

```
Dear Mr. Castillo,

I will close the loop here for now. If the timing suits better closer to your Q3 budget
conversation, I am glad to hold until then and send a one-site scope you could use internally.

Should I check back before your Q3 review, or is a colleague leading this for the three sites?

Kind regards,
Samruddhi Sontakke
Business Development, FlytBase
```

Branches (adapt to his reply)

- **If he replies:** Positive: accepts a slot or asks to talk
  Then: Reply within the business hour, confirm the slot, send the invite with the AE, and log the call in the CRM. Pause the sequence.

```text Dear Mr. Castillo,

Thank you. Wednesday 11 November at 11:00 Santiago time is confirmed, and I will send an invitation with our Account Executive shortly. We will come prepared to discuss how your three sites compare with the iodine deployment.
```

Kind regards, Samruddhi Sontakke Business Development, FlytBase ``` - **If he replies:** Not until Q3 / budget not yet approved
Then: Thank him, offer one small step (a one-site scope or business-case brief for finance), log a check-back date two to three weeks before his Q3 budget conversation, and stop the sequence until then.

```text Dear Mr. Castillo,

Thank you, that is helpful. Would a short one-site scope with a cost outline be useful to bring into the Q3 conversation? I can prepare it whenever suits you and will otherwise check back a few weeks before your Q3 review.

Kind regards, Samruddhi Sontakke Business Development, FlytBase ``` - **If he replies:** Referral to a colleague (for example operations, maintenance and automation, IT or supply chain)
**Then:** Thank him, write to the named colleague (fill the name from his reply) mentioning that Mr. Castillo referred us, and copy him only if he agrees. Update the buying committee in the CRM.

```text Dear Mr./Ms. (surname from his reply),

Mr. Castillo suggested I contact you about drone-based inspection for the three 24/7 lithium sites in the Atacama. SQM's iodine operation already runs autonomous dock inspections on FlytBase in northern Chile. Would a 30-minute call on Wednesday at 11:00 or Thursday at 15:00, Santiago time, be useful?

Kind regards, Samruddhi Sontakke Business Development, FlytBase ``` - **If he replies:** Objection: security or data handling, permits, or 'we already have a contractor or vendor'
**Then:** Acknowledge why it matters, give the approach and one proof point, and ask one follow-up question. Involve the AE for security or permit detail.

```text Dear Mr. Castillo,

That is a fair concern for 24/7 sites. In SQM's iodine programme, drone data already flows into SQM's own Azure environment, so your IT team keeps control of where it is stored. Which requirement matters most to your team, so I can bring the right specialist to a short call?

Kind regards, Samruddhi Sontakke Business Development, FlytBase ``` - **If he replies:** Out of office
**Then:** Pause the sequence until the business day after his return date, note any named stand-in, and resend the latest step then. Do not write to the stand-in unless the auto-reply invites it.

`text (No reply sent. Resume on the business day after his return with: 'Dear Mr. Castillo, welcome back. Following your request about inspection for the three Atacama lithium sites, would Tuesday at 11:00 or Wednesday at 15:00, Santiago time, suit a 30-minute call? Kind regards, Samruddhi Sontakke, Business Development, FlytBase')` - **If he replies:** Polite non-commitment (for example 'lo
```

vamos a ver')
Then: Log as not-yet, not as interest. Confirm in writing what happens next and when.

```text Dear Mr. Castillo,

Thank you for considering it. I will check back in early December unless you prefer another date, and I am happy to send the one-site scope earlier if it helps your team.

Kind regards, Samruddhi Sontakke Business Development, FlytBase ``` - **If he replies:** No reply after Email 4
**Then:** Mark as ghost, not dead. Move to value nurture every 4-6 weeks (case study, implementation approach, objections, scoped pilot) and one refreshed touch before his Q3 budget conversation.

```text (Nurture touch, about 6 weeks later) Dear Mr. Castillo,

Ahead of your Q3 budget conversation, a one-site scope for one of your Atacama sites is ready whenever useful. Should I send it?

Kind regards, Samruddhi Sontakke Business Development, FlytBase ``` - **If he replies:** No / unsubscribe / hostile
**Then:** Stop on every channel immediately, do not argue, mark do-not-contact in the CRM.

```text Dear Mr. Castillo,

Understood, thank you for letting me know. I will not contact you further.

Kind regards, Samruddhi Sontakke Business Development, FlytBase ```

## Stage 4 - Case Study Match

*Scanned 25 case studies on flytbase.com.*

**Best match:** How SQM Turned a 678 km² Mine into an Autonomous Inspection Zone

This case study is about the lead's own company. SQM already runs DJI Dock-based autonomous inspection on FlytBase across a 678 km² operation in the Atacama Desert, the same desert, country and kind of operation as Rodrigo Castillo's 3 lithium sites. It shows manual field inspection (engineers walking or driving kilometers under the desert sun) being replaced by daily autonomous missions, which maps directly to his goal of replacing expensive, hazardous contracted crews. It also names the local integrator (Adentu) and the data pipeline (FlytBase to Azure) that SQM has already approved internally, which lowers technical and procurement risk before the Q3 budget
```

conversation. Expanding from an existing internal success to the Northern Operations Division is a far stronger argument than any outside reference.

- SQM "cut inspection time from days to hours"
- "achieved more than 95 percent mission reliability"
- "doubled inspection frequency"
- "improved iodine extraction yield by two percent"
- 678 km^2 mining operation in northern Chile (Atacama Desert)
- "It was the first time SQM's inspection team could start their day with a ranked list of priorities generated entirely by autonomous systems."

How to use it: Open with the internal proof point: 'Your colleagues on SQM's Digital Innovation team (Rodrigo Toler) already run FlytBase with Adentu across 678 km^2 in the Atacama.' Position the Northern Operations request as scaling a proven internal programme to 3 more 24/7 sites, not a new pilot. Ask whether he knows the Digital Innovation team and offer an introduction or joint call with Adentu. Use the >95% reliability, days-to-hours and doubled-frequency metrics in the Q3 budget business case. Note the page headline says '4× iodine yield' while the body says a two percent improvement, so quote the body text.

Runner-up: How Anglo American Uses Autonomous Drones to Transform Mining Safety in Peru - This is the referrer's own FlytBase deployment: drone-in-a-box at the Quellaveco copper mine in Peru with LATAM partner UAV LATAM. It replaced manual drone flights and truck travel across inaccessible, mountainous terrain to cut travel time and personnel safety exposure. Use it to acknowledge the referral and as a peer LATAM mining reference for safety and remote-site connectivity (elevated dock placement).

Referral connection (Anglo American): FlytBase's site has an Anglo American case study. Anglo American deployed FlytBase-powered drone-in-a-box technology at its Quellaveco copper mine in Peru through implementation partner UAV LATAM. The deployment replaced manual drone flights and truck transport between survey locations, improving personnel safety in mountainous terrain, and the case study frames it as a new standard for mining safety in Latin America. The likely referral path is a mining peer who has seen autonomous docks working in LATAM. link

Existing relationship with SQM: Yes. SQM partnered with Chile-based integrator Adentu and FlytBase to automate inspection across its 678 km^2 operation in northern Chile. It started as a single-DJI-Dock pilot detecting irrigation leaks and leaching inefficiencies and grew into a daily automated inspection ecosystem, with RGB and thermal imagery feeding SQM's Azure ML environment. Reported results: inspection time from days to hours, >95% mission reliability, doubled inspection frequency and a 2% iodine extraction yield improvement. The case study names Rodrigo Toler (Deputy Manager of Digital Innovation, SQM). The inbound lead comes from a different person and

division (Rodrigo Castillo, Northern Operations Division) and does not mention this, so treat it as account expansion and coordinate with the existing account owner and Adentu. link

People named on FlytBase's site (warm contacts)

- **Rodrigo Toler**, Deputy Manager of Digital Innovation, SQM - Internal SQM champion of the existing FlytBase deployment. He can vouch internally to the Northern Operations Division and is a potential coach for the Q3 budget decision. [S1]
- **José Pablo Mujica**, Commercial Manager, Adentu - Commercial contact at the Chile-based integrator already delivering FlytBase at SQM, and the likely partner for a partner-led expansion. [S1]
- **Kimberly Rojas Ruiz**, , UAV LATAM - Quoted on the referrer's (Anglo American) Quellaveco deployment. A possible contact at the LATAM partner behind the referral reference. [S2]

Case study	Fit	Industry	Use case	Context
How SQM Turned a 678 km² Mine into an Autonomous Inspection Zone	97	Exact: SQM itself, mining (lithium, iodine, nitrate).	Strong: replaces manual field-engineer walking/driving inspections with daily autonomous dock-based RGB and thermal inspection. The lead wants to replace expensive, hazardous contracted crews.	Exact: Atacama Desert, northern Chile, 678 km2 open-area operation, DJI Dock, local integrator Adentu.
How Anglo American Uses Autonomous Drones to Transform Mining Safety in Peru	88	Strong: large-scale mining (Quellaveco copper mine). This is the referrer's own deployment.	Good: autonomous drone-in-a-box replacing manual drone flights and truck travel for topographic surveys, with personnel safety as a driver.	Good: LATAM (Peru), extensive and inaccessible mine areas, mountainous terrain, LATAM partner UAV LATAM. Copper rather than lithium, and survey rather than inspection.
How Anglo American Uses Autonomous Drones to Transform Mining Safety in Peru (www duplicate)	88	Duplicate of S2 (same page, www hostname).	Same as S2.	Same as S2.
How CSX Enhances Rail Safety with	45	Weak: rail transportation.	Moderate: autonomous inspection that removes personnel from dangerous	Weak: US rail yards. The useful parallel is multi-site scale.

Case study	Fit	Industry	Use case	Context
Autonomous Drone Inspections			situations, multi-site (13 sites across 10 locations).	
How TNB Reduced Warehouse Inventory Verification Time by 90x with Autonomous Drones In Malaysia	35	Weak: energy utility warehouse.	Partial: replaces months-long manual inspection with dock-based autonomous monitoring.	Weak: 43-hectare storage facility in Malaysia, though it uses Starlink connectivity, which is relevant to remote sites.
MSS Security Transforms Airport Safety with BVLOS Drone Operations in Australia	25	Weak: site security / airport.	Weak: nighttime perimeter security inspections.	Weak: Australia, airport BVLOS regulatory precedent.

Stage 5 - Partner & Go-to-Market Motion

Recommended motion: AE-led with partner (co-sell)

- **Region:** LATAM, Chile: 3 remote 24/7 lithium sites in the Atacama Desert. Docks need on-site installation, dock-placement surveys, Spanish-language field support and local DGAC/DAN 151 regulatory handling, which is best done by an in-country integrator. FlytBase's own SQM case study (S1) shows this pattern: a Chile-based integrator ran the ground-reality check, dock placement and middleware.
- **Deal Complexity:** High. Enterprise mining buyer with 3 large sites, multiple stakeholders (Northern Operations, Digital Innovation, IT/OT for the Azure pipeline, safety, procurement), a Q3 budget cycle and an unknown paper process. This justifies a FlytBase AE owning the account, the commercial relationship and the expansion business case, with a partner handling hardware supply, installation and local support.
- **Partner Availability:** Good. FlytBase's partner directory (S16) lists Dronestore Chile as a Gold System Integrator in Chile, plus LATAM partners UAVLatam (Bronze System Integrator, Argentina), Drone Nerds LATAM (Gold Reseller, Colombia), Runco (Gold Reseller, Argentina) and Martin Fablet (Gold System Integrator, Uruguay). Adentu, the integrator on the existing SQM deployment, appears in the SQM case study (S1) but not in the partner directory listing.
- **Existing Account Relationship:** Yes. SQM already runs FlytBase with DJI Docks across a 678 km2 Atacama operation, delivered by the Chile-based integrator Adentu (S1), with Rodrigo Toler (Deputy Manager of Digital Innovation, SQM) as the internal champion. This lead is

account expansion into the Northern Operations Division, so the AE should coordinate with the existing SQM account owner and bring Adentu in first.

Partner	Type	Country	Evidence	Role in deal	Verified in sources
Adentu	System Integrator	Chile	"That need led them to Adentu, a Chile-based integrator specializing in drone autonomy, and FlytBase" ... "Adentu's engineers started small: one DJI Dock, one zone, one use case." ... "Adentu built middleware that allowed data to flow seamlessly between FlytBase and Azure."	First choice. Adentu already delivered FlytBase at SQM in the Atacama. It knows SQM's sites, people, Azure data pipeline and vendor onboarding, which lowers technical and procurement risk before the Q3 budget conversation. Role: site survey and dock placement for the 3 Northern Operations sites, hardware supply and installation, extension of the FlytBase-to-Azure middleware, and local field support. Contact named in the case study: Jose Pablo Mujica, Commercial Manager.	yes
Dronestore Chile	System Integrator	Chile	Listed on FlytBase's partner network page as "Dronestore Chile Gold System Integrator Solution Provider Chile". Tabulado (S19) reports that Dronestore exhibited the DJI Dock 2 and Matrice 3D/3DT ecosystem at Exponor 2024, northern Chile's main mining fair.	In-country backup or capacity partner. It is the only Gold-tier FlytBase System Integrator listed in Chile and is visible in the northern Chile mining market with DJI Dock hardware. Use it if Adentu lacks capacity for 3 additional 24/7 sites, or if SQM procurement wants a competing local quote.	yes
UAVLatam	System Integrator	Argentina	Listed on FlytBase's partner network page as "UAVLatam Bronze System Integrator Solution Provider Argentina". The Anglo American case study (S2)	Reference partner tied to the referral. It delivered the referrer's (Anglo American) LATAM mining deployment, so it can support a peer reference call on remote-site dock placement and connectivity.	yes

Partner	Type	Country	Evidence	Role in deal	Verified in sources
			names UAV LATAM as Anglo American's "technology implementation partner" for the Quellaveco drone-in-a-box deployment in Peru.	Regional backup only, because it is based outside Chile.	

Partner profile needed: A Chile-based FlytBase System Integrator with mining experience in the Atacama. It needs DJI Dock supply and installation capability, Spanish-language 24/7 field support at remote desert sites, DGAC/BVLOS regulatory know-how, and data-integration skills (FlytBase to Azure/ML pipelines). It should ideally already be an approved vendor at SQM.

- **flytbase_ae:** Own the SQM expansion opportunity and the commercial relationship. Coordinate with the existing SQM account owner and Rodrigo Toler (Digital Innovation), run discovery with Rodrigo Castillo, build the Q3 business case from the existing SQM deployment results, and lead pricing and licensing (multi-site FlytBase enterprise).
- **partner:** Adentu leads the technical side: site surveys, dock placement, hardware supply and installation for the 3 Northern Operations sites, extension of the Azure middleware, and local first-line support. Dronestore Chile is the backup in-country integrator. UAVLatam is the optional reference partner for the Anglo American connection.
- **bdr:** Respond same business day, confirm the referral and the link to the existing SQM deployment, book the discovery call with the AE, and flag the account-expansion context and the Adentu relationship in the handoff. Ask early about SQM's procurement preference (direct vs through a local integrator).

Stage 6 - AE Handoff Summary

Buyer: Rodrigo Castillo, Head of Operations, Northern Operations Division, SQM (r.castillo@sqm.cl). He came inbound through flytbase.com/contact, referred by Anglo American. He is a senior operational owner, but nobody has confirmed he signs the budget. No public source names his division or his reporting line, so check both on the call.

What he cares about: - Cutting the cost of contracted inspection crews across 3 large-scale lithium sites in the Atacama - Taking people out of hazardous field inspection. Regulators partially suspended work at SQM Salar in Feb 2026 over working conditions, and a contractor there was

suspended over PPE [S25] - Coverage that runs 24/7, matching how the sites operate - Getting a fundable case into the internal Q3 budget conversation

Others likely involved: - Rodrigo Toler, Deputy Manager of Digital Innovation, SQM - Internal champion of the existing FlytBase/Adentu iodine deployment [S1]. He is a possible internal reference or coach, but approach him only after the existing account owner agrees. - José Pablo Mujica, Commercial Manager, Adentu - Commercial contact at the Chile integrator that already delivered FlytBase at SQM [S1]. He is the first-choice delivery partner. - Carlos Díaz, General Manager, Nova Andino Litio (formerly GM of SQM Litio) - Top executive of the lithium business and the likely final sponsor of a multi-site lithium deployment [S12][S13]. - Gerson Salas, Maintenance and Automation Manager - Natural technical evaluator for dock-based inspection [S12]. - Andrés Pinto, Digitalization and IT Manager - IT/OT, data integration and cybersecurity sign-off [S12]. - Germán Pérez, Supply Chain Manager - Likely owner of vendor onboarding and the paper process [S12]. - Luis Acuña, Risk Management Superintendency - Owns the safety and risk case for removing people from hazardous inspection [S12]. - Q3 budget signer (unknown) - The economic buyer is not identified. It could be Rodrigo, a VP of Operations or corporate.

Qualification: MEDDPICC - ICP 88/100, completeness 38%, priority 73/100, P1 - Hot: respond same business day, involve AE early
Knowns: Identify Pain (known): contracted crews are expensive and hazardous; Metrics (partial): cost and safety pain stated but not quantified; Economic Buyer and Decision Process (partial): an internal budget conversation is scheduled for Q3; Champion (partial): Rodrigo reached out on his own as a senior operations owner; Scope: 3 large-scale, 24/7 lithium extraction sites in the Atacama Desert, Chile; Warm intro: referred by Anglo American
Unknowns: Metrics: annual spend on contracted crews, inspection frequency, incident rates, target savings; Economic Buyer: who joins the Q3 conversation and who gives final sign-off; Decision Criteria: what a system must prove (heat, dust, altitude, night ops, integration, security, pricing model); Decision Process: steps after Q3 budget, pilot expectations, go-live target; Paper Process: direct vs local integrator, vendor and security review, and which entity contracts (Novandino or SQM S.A.); Champion: whether Rodrigo will actively sponsor the project internally; Competition: other drone or robotics vendors versus staying with the contracted crews; Which 3 sites he means and how they relate to the existing iodine program

Top 3 research highlights 1. SQM is already a FlytBase customer. With Chilean integrator Adentu it runs DJI Docks on FlytBase across a 678 km^2 iodine operation in northern Chile: two autonomous missions a day, RGB and thermal data into SQM's Azure, inspection frequency doubled, more than 95% mission reliability, and a USD 70-80k system that paid back in under a year. SQM has also ordered extra docks for 24/7 security surveillance [S1]. - *This is an expansion, not a cold deal. The integrator, data path and payback benchmark already exist inside SQM. Coordinate with the existing account owner and Adentu before outreach, and build the Q3 business case on these numbers.* 1. Since

Dec 27, 2025, SQM's Salar de Atacama lithium business has run as Nova Andino Litio SpA, a Codelco-SQM joint venture with a 3+3 board chaired by Codelco's Máximo Pacheco. Carlos Díaz (ex-GM of SQM Litio) is general manager, and the JV started with SQM Litio's 3,533 workers [S9] [S13][S14][S12]. - *If his sites are lithium, the contracting entity and procurement rules may be Novandino's, not SQM S.A.'s. The iodine reference may also sit in a different legal entity. Confirm the entity early and bring a governance-ready security and compliance package.* 1. SQM guided about US$3B of 2026-2028 capex: roughly 60% for Novandino, plus about US$300M a year of sustaining capex across divisions. H1 2026 net income was US$1,024.7M versus US$225.9M a year earlier, and lithium was 78% of gross profit [S10]. In 2025 SQM had cut capex and delayed some investment decisions [S7][S8]. - *The budget climate for the Q3 conversation is much better than in 2025, but management stays capital-disciplined. Pitch the deal as a sustaining, cost-reduction project with fast payback, not a discretionary capex line.*

Case study: How SQM Turned a 678 km² Mine into an Autonomous Inspection Zone - It is about the lead's own company, in the same desert and country, replacing manual field inspection with daily autonomous dock missions. That maps directly to replacing contracted crews. It names the integrator (Adentu) and the data pipeline (FlytBase to Azure) SQM has already approved, which lowers technical and procurement risk before Q3 [S1]. Quote the body text (2% iodine yield improvement), not the headline's '4x'. Secondary: Anglo American Quellaveco (Peru, with UAV LATAM) [S2] acknowledges the referrer and serves as a LATAM mining peer reference. It was not fact-checked in research, so use it on the call only.

GTM motion: AE-led with partner (co-sell). The FlytBase AE owns the SQM expansion, the commercial relationship and pricing. Adentu (Chile System Integrator, already delivering at SQM [S1]) handles site surveys, dock placement, installation, the Azure middleware and local support. Dronestore Chile (Gold SI, partner directory [S16]) is the in-country backup. UAVLatam (Bronze SI, Argentina [S16]) is an optional reference tied to the Anglo American deployment.

Next step: Confirm the existing SQM account owner and Adentu's partner status, and agree deal registration and roles. Then send Email 1 and hold a 30-minute discovery call with Rodrigo Castillo on Wed 11 Nov 11:00 or Thu 12 Nov 15:00 Santiago time. Use the call to map the 3 sites to an entity, the Q3 budget attendees and signer, crew cost and frequency, and decision criteria. (owner: AE (BDR sends Email 1 and books the call), by: Internal alignment and Email 1 today, Fri 6 Nov 2026. Discovery call by Thu 12 Nov 2026.)
Why: P1 lead with a warm referral and a scheduled Q3 budget conversation, so speed matters. SQM is already a FlytBase/Adentu customer [S1], so outreach without internal alignment risks channel conflict and a confusing message. Discovery must close the unknowns that decide whether this lands in the Q3 budget: economic buyer, entity and paper process, and metrics.

Watch-outs: Channel conflict: the SQM relationship may already be owned by Adentu or another FlytBase account owner. Adentu is in the SQM case study but not in the public partner directory, so

confirm its status before naming it.; Entity ambiguity: lithium assets moved into Novandino (Codelco-SQM JV) [S9][S13]. Procurement may follow JV rules, separate from the iodine team that ran the first deployment.; Nobody has confirmed which 3 sites he means, and no public source names the 'Northern Operations Division'. Confirm before scoping or quoting.; Budget is not approved and depends on the Q3 conversation. SQM delayed some investments in 2025 [S7][S8], so a big multi-site upfront spend may slip. Offer a one-site scope.; Harsh conditions (about 2,300 m altitude, large temperature swings at SQM Salar [S25]) will draw technical scrutiny, and the iodine reliability figures are vendor-published [S1].; Don't make claims about the Anglo American-SQM relationship. The research found no public record beyond FlytBase's own case studies.

Sources

- **S1** How SQM Turned a 678 km² Mine into an Autonomous Inspection Zone | FlytBase | FlytBase *(case_study)*
- **S2** How Anglo American Uses Autonomous Drones to Transform Mining Safety in Peru | FlytBase Case Study | FlytBase *(case_study)*
- **S3** How Anglo American Uses Autonomous Drones to Transform Mining Safety in Peru | FlytBase Case Study | FlytBase *(case_study)*
- **S4** MSS Security Transforms Airport Safety with BVLOS Drone Operations in Australia | FlytBase *(case_study)*
- **S5** How CSX Enhances Rail Safety with Autonomous Drone Inspections | FlytBase *(case_study)*
- **S6** How TNB Reduced Warehouse Inventory Verification Time by 90x with Autonomous Drones In Malaysia | FlytBase *(case_study)*
- **S7** 050c64fe-46d4-48b6-8b06-84cb5ddddf2e *(budget_signals)*
- **S8** Lithium price rebound lifts SQM profits and demand outlook - Miningreporters.com *(budget_signals)*
- **S9** Codelco and SQM form NovaAndino Litio, the joint venture for the development of lithium in the Salar de Atacama | CODELCO - Corporación Nacional del Cobre, Chile *(org_structure)*
- **S10** SEC Filing | SQM *(budget_signals)*
- **S11** Document *(recent_news)*
- **S12** Expertos en litio, un hidrogeólogo italiano y hasta con 30 años en SQM: los 14 ejecutivos clave de NovaAndino | Diario Financiero *(org_structure)*
- **S13** Nova Andino parte con 3.533 trabajadores y el Estado se hace de los más preciados activos de SQM en Chile y China | Diario Financiero *(org_structure)*
- **S14** Con más de 3.500 trabajadores: NovaAndino da el puntapié a sus operaciones de litio - Revista Digital Minera REDIMIN *(org_structure)*
- **S15** How SQM Achieved 4x Iodine Yield Improvement and Cut Inspection Time by 99% | FlytBase *(technology_adoption)*

- **S16** Partner network | FlytBase *(partner_directory)*
- **S17** sqm-20251231 *(operations_context)*
- **S18** 7349167c-4521-408c-9a1b-8a5229486815 *(investor_priorities)*
- **S19** Exponor 2024 - Tabulado *(web)*
- **S20** SQM reporta récord en ventas en cuarto trimestre del 2025 y estima que el mercado del litio podría crecer un 25% este año *(recent_news)*
- **S21** The Lithium Evolution: ANDRITZ's Strategic Solutions for SQM *(technology_adoption)*
- **S22** SQM Yodo Nutrición Vegetal apuesta por la industria 4.0: innovación tecnológica y cultura de mejora continua - Reporte Minero | El portal de minería en Chile *(technology_adoption)*
- **S23** SQM optimiza producción de nitratos y logra precisión de modelos predictivos en torno a 90% con soluciones de AVEVA - Guía Minera de Chile *(technology_adoption)*
- **S24** Hecho con Chile: SQM Group unifica su estructura para acelerar su crecimiento - Reporte Minero | El portal de minería en Chile *(recent_news)*
- **S25** Dirección del Trabajo suspende parcialmente faenas de SQM Salar por incumplimientos en higiene y seguridad - DT - Noticias *(operations_context)*
- **S26** Trabajador fallece en accidente ocurrido en faena Nueva Victoria - Reporte Minero | El portal de minería en Chile *(operations_context)*
- **S27** Reddit r/Lithium: LAC, SQM..BUYING? *(reddit)*
- **S28** Reddit r/chile: Caso SQM vuelve a tribunales: Corte revisa recursos que buscan anular absoluciones *(reddit)*
- **S29** Reddit r/chile: Triple ofensiva para reabrir caso SQM: Fiscalía, CDE y SII piden anular el juicio y las absoluciones *(reddit)*
- **S30** Reddit r/chile: el cartel de zaliasnik pt 3: las angeles de la guarda (gracias reportea) *(reddit)*
- **S31** Reddit r/chile: el cartel de zaliasnik: justicia vip a la medida de la derecha *(reddit)*
- **S32** Reddit r/chile: Nivel de impunidad en Chile *(reddit)*
- **S33** Reddit r/chile: Steinert es la representación pública de la cultura del pituto Chileno. *(reddit)*
- **S34** Reddit r/chile: Crisis de los fertilizantes puede impulsar SQM, opiniones? *(reddit)*
- **S35** Reddit r/chile: SQM busca operadores, mantenedores, analistas y profesionales: revisa vacantes activas para postular en minería *(reddit)*
- **S36** Reddit r/UAVmapping: Question: How many hectares/sqm can the Matrice 350 cover per flight? *(reddit)*
- **S37** Reddit r/drones: Do you think there is a need for a tandem quadcopter/quadplane for long-range high-precision imaging? *(reddit)*
- **S38** Reddit r/drones: 10 Best Drone Drone Docking Stations (2023) *(reddit)*